Consulting CV checklist

Twenty checks to run before your CV goes to a consulting firm, from layout to the last full stop.

Structure

- [ ] One page, unless you have more than ten years of experience
- [ ] Education and experience in reverse date order
- [ ] Each role shows company, title, location and dates on one line
- [ ] Clean, consistent font, with margins of at least 1.5 cm
- [ ] No photo, objective statement or list of soft skills

Bullets

- [ ] Each bullet starts with a strong verb: led, built, cut, grew
- [ ] Each bullet shows a result, not only a task
- [ ] Results have a number: money, time, percentage or scale
- [ ] No bullet runs over two lines
- [ ] Three to five bullets for each recent role

What a reader looks for

- [ ] Leadership: a time you ran something or brought people with you
- [ ] Problem solving: a messy problem you structured and solved
- [ ] Impact: a change that lasted after you left
- [ ] Ranks, scholarships and selective programmes are easy to spot
- [ ] Interests are specific enough to start a conversation

Final pass

- [ ] Spelling and grammar checked by a person, not only by software
- [ ] Dates, tenses and number formats are consistent
- [ ] File saved as a PDF and named Firstname-Lastname-CV
- [ ] Every claim is something you can talk about for two minutes
- [ ] A friend can say what you are best at after a 30-second read

Want someone to check your work?

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